

**Article Review #1**

George Rector

Old Dominion University

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## **Introduction**

For this essay I decided to write about an article called *The Role of International Law in Combating Illicit Drug Trafficking Via the Dark Web* by Dr. Mohga Mohamed Abd El-Karim of the Naif Arab University of Security Sciences. This article describes how drug trafficking transcends national and international laws, and how access to the dark web via Tor browsers makes it almost impossible to track down international drug traffickers and the complex legal loopholes they abuse.

## **Principles of Social Science**

This article describes multiple social science principles that I am going to outline. Firstly, relativism. This article describes how different countries with different laws make it hard to enforce drug trafficking on an international stage. One of these issues is with extraditions. A country might have different requirements for extraditing drug traffickers to another country. For example, if a Colombian drug lord has an operation in Colombia, they might be indicted in a United States court of law. But the Colombian government doesn't have an extradition policy with the United States, that makes it a legal quagmire with extraditing a Colombian citizen to the United States.

Objectivity is another principle that the author acknowledges. He strived to maintain objectivity with regard to international and national laws. He cites the 1961 UN charter on Drug Trafficking as an example. This law provides gaps when it pertains to local enforcement of laws, and the lack of countries involved in drug trafficking willing to allow an international presence in their countries to combat the traffickers. This is also echoed by Tor servers that sell drugs on illegal websites.

## **Research Procedure**

- **Main Objective:** To evaluate the role of existing international laws to combat drug trafficking across the globe, with regards to cybersecurity and illegal websites.
- **Hypothesis:** Current international laws provide some foundations to combat drug trafficking but are inefficient when it comes to online drug websites.
- **Independent variable:** Strength and legitimacy of current drug trafficking laws
- **Dependent variable:** Success of using international laws to combat drug trafficking, especially when it pertains to dark web drug websites.

### **Type of Research Used**

This article used the Doctrinal Research method. This research method uses library-based research and uses a lot of secondary sources. The article cites many legal sources such as the 1961 UN Charter on illicit drug trafficking or the 2001 Budapest Convention on Cybercrime. The article uses secondary sources such as drug reports from different countries, and Interpol drug reports.

### **Data Analysis**

The article uses data sources from all over the world; these include drug reports from common drug trafficking countries such as Colombia and Mexico. They also include sources from Interpol drug database. The author uses these sources to study how drug crime is becoming more common and harder to enforce with online drug websites.

### **Conclusion**

In conclusion, the Article by Dr. Mohga Mohamed Abd El-Karim shows how old international laws are slowly becoming obsolete with enforcing modern drug trafficking. The rise of illegal Tor websites selling drugs to an international market. The article shows that if the world wants to take drug trafficking seriously, we need to update our laws to make sure we can

also combat the people running illegal drug trafficking servers, along with the traffickers themselves.

## References

Abd El-Karim, M. M. (2025). The role of international law in combating illicit drug trafficking via the dark web. *International Journal of Cyber Criminology*, 19(1), 239–271.  
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